Some open ended questions

- During your school sport day, it is planned to conduct a mini marathon race within the school campus. They decided that the running distance be 2 kilometres. Is it possible to have a school campus with the circumference of 2km? Discuss with your friends, how big the campus should be. Give other options if it is not a big campus.
- Is the distance in the sea also calculated in kilometres? How is it possible to calculate the distance in sea water? Explore!
- We know that the distance between celestial bodies is calculated in terms of light year. Light year is the distance travelled by light in one year. Now without calculator find how many kilometres light would have travelled in a year. Get the speed of light from your teacher.
- We see that the distances between Chennai and Madurai is written as '462' kms. But from which point to which point is this distance calculated?. As we are science students we need to know it with the precision. Is it between the two bus stands? Or between the two railway stations? Discuss and figure it out. Check your answers with your teacher.
- A person needs to drink two litres of water a day. Note down how much water you drink each day? Make a rough calculation and check if you are drinking the required amount of water.

Points to Remember

- The comparison of an unknown quantity with some known quantity is known as measurement.
- All physical quantities have standard units for the sake of uniformity.
- Length, mass and time are some of the fundamental physical quantities.
- The SI units are:

Length	-	metre
Mass	-	kilogram
Time	-	second

- While using a ruler, the accurate measurement can be arrived by avoiding three types of possible errors.
- Electronic balance is an instrument which provides accurate measurement of mass correct upto milligram.

Evaluation

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I. Choose the correct answer.

1. The height of a tree can be measured by

   a) metre scale c) plastic ruler

   b) metre rod d) measuring tape

2. Conversion of 7 m into cm gives _____

   a) 70 cm c) 700 cm

   b) 7 cm d) 7000 cm

3. Quantity that can be measured is called ____

   a) physical quantity c) unit

   b) measurement d) motion